AI can help me with my burnout... *right?*

how to (get) help

pete nuwayser @ LLMday NYC 2026 Q4 | 2026.10.29

hey, I’m pete

Head of European Operations & Principal Engineer @ Stigian Consulting LLC

- Boston expat in Brooklyn since 2025
- Baines Zack
- In Our Hearts NYC, Food Not Bombs Bed-Stuy, vote.nyc
- Toured the US & UK several times 2008-2015
- Job as drum solo
- Whimsy and gregariousness so off-the-charts, you may find it bewildering
- Neurospicy with a side of Auditory Processing Disorder



today: let's talk about whether AI makes burnout more or less likely

- a quick personal story
- burnout 101
- **let's hear from you**
- resources

your "prompts" for our discussion

tell us about a time when...

1. AI helped me manage my energy, feel good about my skills, or get more engaged with my company

2. Using AI brought more physical / emotional exhaustion, increased feelings of personal inefficacy, or made me cynical about my company

3. I found a way to use AI to manage the tasks that used to stress me out

4. I tried to use AI to reduce my stress, but it didn't go as planned

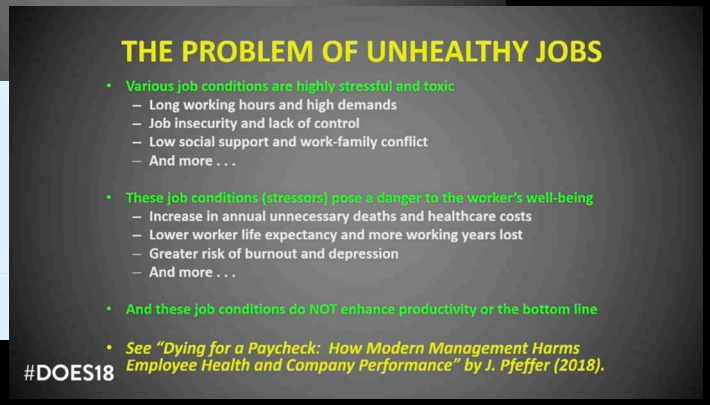
a personal story

- Experienced burnout at work > 1x
- Lost energy, enthusiasm, confidence
- Feeling ^^ with increasing frequency
- Missing focus, flow, or joy in my daily work
- Misplaced, unhealthy attempts to make myself more resilient & happy
- Constant triage

first learned about burnout from the 🐐







Dr. Christina Maslach presentation at DevOps Enterprise Summit 2018 Las Vegas: Understanding Job Burnout https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gRPBkCW0R5E

how I (got) helped

- **Conducted Open Spaces at DevOps Days**
  - *What Does Psychological Safety Look Like?* - NYC 2020
  - *Burnout: How to (get) Help* - NYC 2020, Boston 2019
  - *Patterns for Engineering Team Happiness* - DC 2019
  - *Are We Having Fun Yet?* - DC 2018
- **Gave Internal presentations at Deloitte & IBM**
- **Joined Friends of the Mount Vernon Trail**
- **Provide individual mentoring & coaching**
  - because you can have everything in life you want,
    if you will just help enough other people get what they want

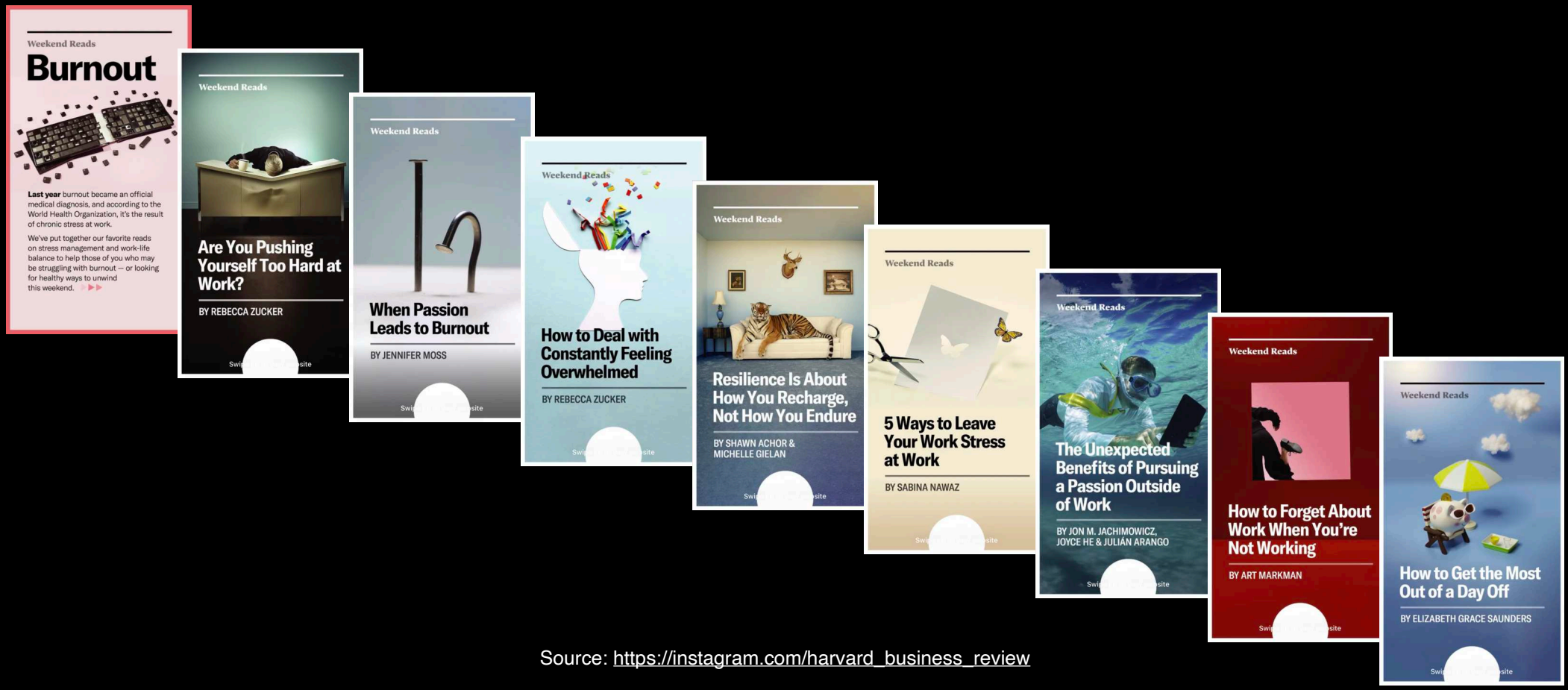


burnout 101

an old definition

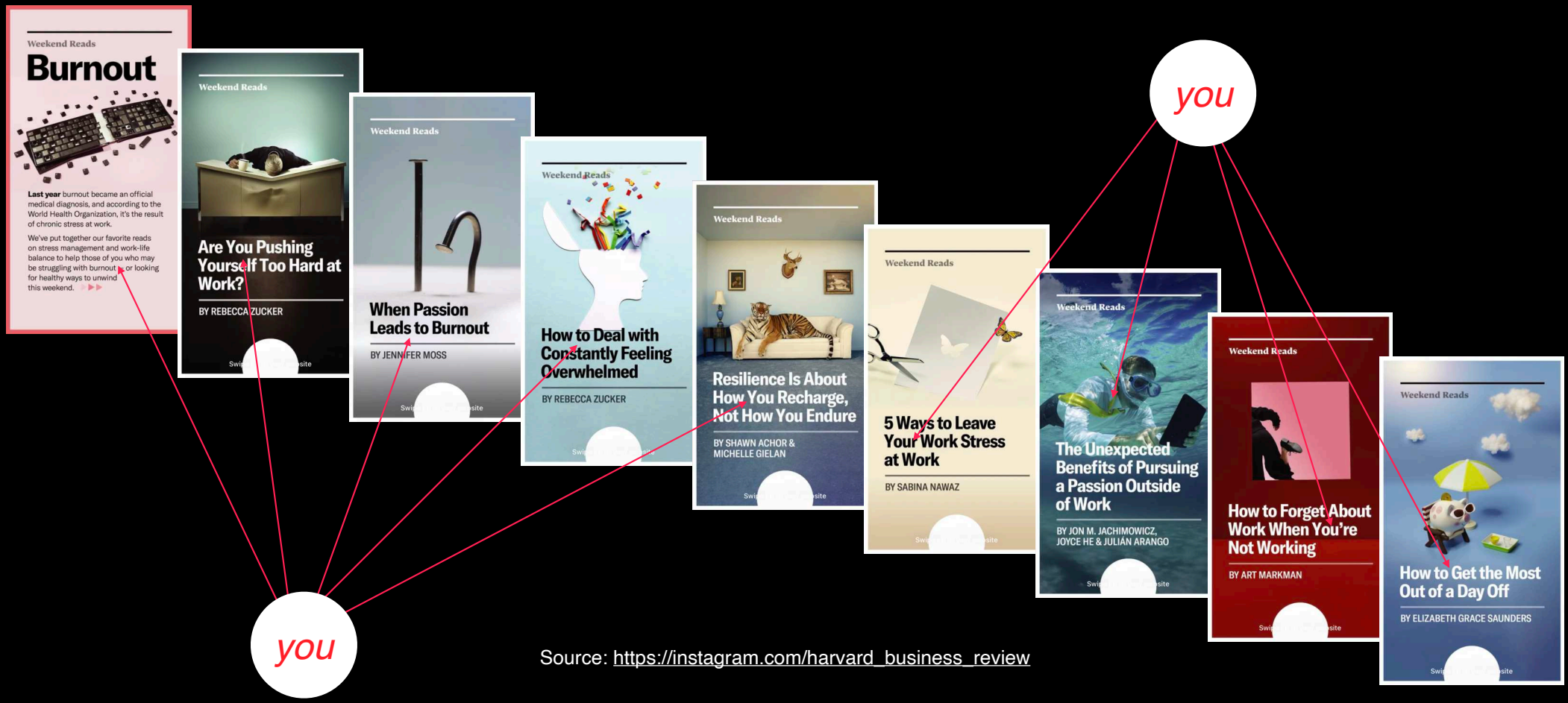
- **WHO International Classification of Diseases version 10 (ICD-10): Version 2019**
  - XXI Factors influencing health status and contact with health services
    - Z70-Z76 Persons encountering health services in other circumstances
      - Z73 Problems related to ***life-management difficulty***
        - **Z73.0 Burn-out: State of vital exhaustion**
          - Approximate synonyms:
            - Burnout
            - **Physical and emotional exhaustion state**

a question of resilience…



Source: https://instagram.com/harvard_business_review

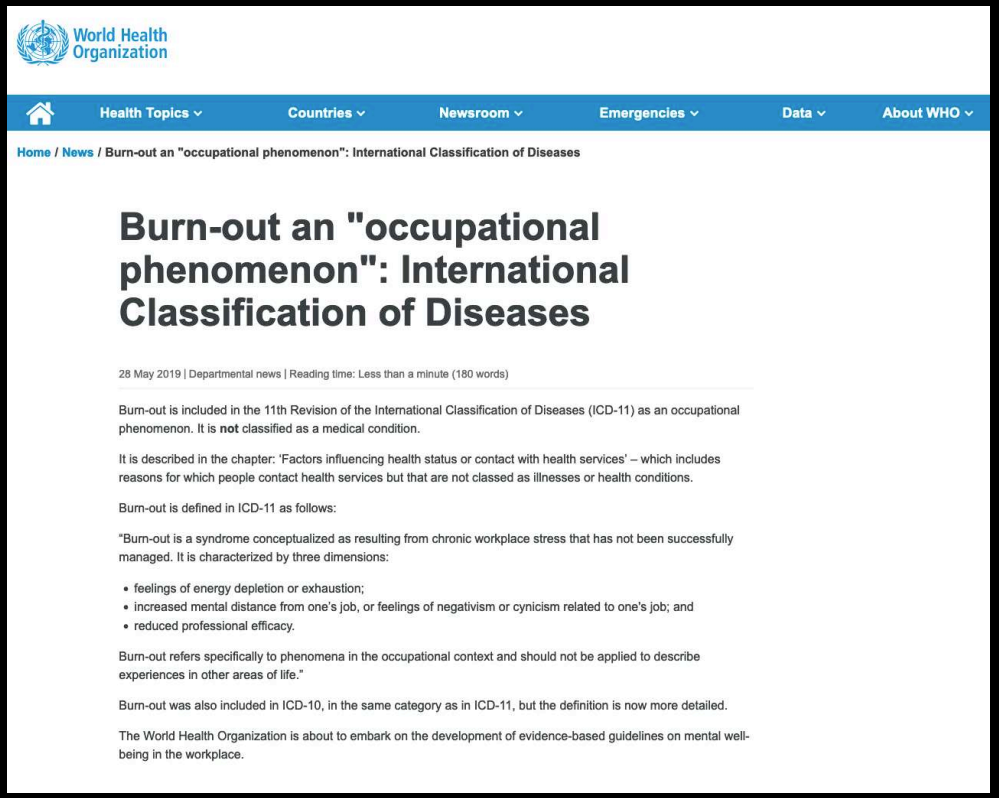
a question of resilience… whose? *yours?*



Source: https://instagram.com/harvard_business_review

a newer, better definition

- **ICD-11 (02/2022)**
  - 24: Factors influencing health status or contact with health services
    - Factors influencing health status
      - Problems associated with employment or unemployment
        - **QD85 Burnout**



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Burn-out an "occupational phenomenon": International Classification of Diseases

28 May 2019 | Departmental news | Reading time: Less than a minute (180 words)

Burn-out is included in the 11th Revision of the International Classification of Diseases (ICD-11) as an occupational phenomenon. It is **not** classified as a medical condition.

It is described in the chapter: 'Factors influencing health status or contact with health services' – which includes reasons for which people contact health services but that are not classed as illnesses or health conditions.

Burn-out is defined in ICD-11 as follows:

"Burn-out is a syndrome conceptualized as resulting from chronic workplace stress that has not been successfully managed. It is characterized by three dimensions:

- feelings of energy depletion or exhaustion;
- increased mental distance from one's job, or feelings of negativism or cynicism related to one's job; and
- reduced professional efficacy.

Burn-out refers specifically to phenomena in the occupational context and should not be applied to describe experiences in other areas of life."

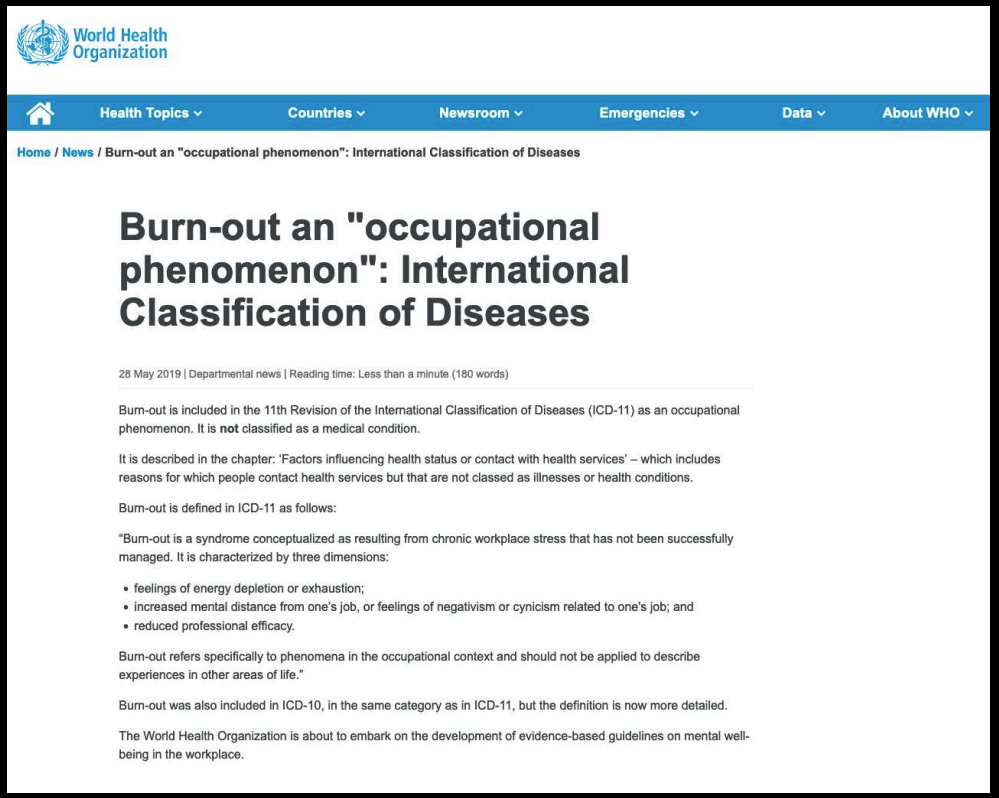
Burn-out was also included in ICD-10, in the same category as in ICD-11, but the definition is now more detailed.

The World Health Organization is about to embark on the development of evidence-based guidelines on mental well-being in the workplace.

https://www.who.int/news/item/28-05-2019-burn-out-an-occupational-phenomenon-international-classification-of-diseases

highlights

- “**occupational phenomenon**” not a medical condition
- “chronic workplace stress **that has not been successfully managed**”
  - *by whom?*
- **three dimensions**



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- Feelings of energy depletion or **exhaustion**

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three dimensions

- Feelings of energy depletion or **exhaustion**
- Increased mental distance from one's job, or feelings of negativism or **cynicism** related to one's job
- A sense of **inefficacy** and lack of accomplishment

it’s not (only) about you

- Occupational burnout is much more about the resilience of the **organization**, not only of the individual.
- You can treat the individual as if they have clinical depression, but the source problems are **upstream.**
- Recovery is 30% about healing yourself + **70% about roles and actions you take to help heal the organization.**
- That’s why I talk about burnout.

let's hear from you

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resources

resources that work (for me)



Understanding Job Burnout
Dr. Christina Maslach Presentation at DOES18 Las Vegas (33 minutes)
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gRPBkCW0R5E



Maslach Burnout Indicator - General Survey (MBI-GS): ($15, 15 minutes)
https://www.mindgarden.com/mbi-general-survey/177-mbigs-individual-report.html



MBI-GS Sample Report (free)
https://www.mindgarden.com/index.php?controller=attachment&id_attachment=214



The Balanced Calendar: How to Optimize Your Time
Dominica DeGrandis Presentation at DOES17 Las Vegas (32 minutes)
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UcY542gBap0

what else can I tell you?